

THE GLAMSQUAD SALON

Business Requirements Document

BRD | Profitability & Operational Analytics | May–Aug 2025

Document Control	Details
Client	The GlamSquad Salon
Role	Business Analyst + Data Analyst
Primary Stakeholder	Salon manager
Engagement Type	Direct client engagement
Business Problem	Declining profitability
Data Coverage	Approximately one year
Sources	Excel and handwritten operational records
Tools	Excel, Google Sheets, SQL, Python and Power BI
Status	Portfolio reconstruction based on confirmed engagement facts
Important: This BRD reconstructs the confirmed business requirements for portfolio/interview use. It is not presented as a verbatim historical client-approved BRD or formal sign-off record.	

1. Purpose

This Business Requirements Document defines the business need, objectives, scope, stakeholders, analytical requirements, reporting expectations, success criteria, constraints and evidence boundaries for the GlamSquad Salon profitability and operational analytics engagement.

2. Business Background

The salon was experiencing declining profitability. Operational information existed across Excel and handwritten records, but the information was fragmented and not analysis-ready. Management needed a consolidated, data-supported understanding of the factors affecting profit and practical recommendations that could be implemented.

3. Business Problem Statement

Problem statement: Management needed to understand why profitability was declining and determine whether pricing, discounts, service mix, staffing, scheduling, commissions, material costs, appointment utilization, cancellations/no-shows, customer behaviour or other operating factors were contributing to the problem.

4. Business Objectives

ID	Objective
OBJ-01	Diagnose the principal revenue, cost and operational drivers affecting profitability.
OBJ-02	Create reliable analytical visibility from fragmented and unclear operational records.
OBJ-03	Understand appointment utilization, peak-demand patterns, cancellations and no-shows.
OBJ-04	Evaluate repeat-customer and retention behaviour.
OBJ-05	Assess service performance, pricing, discounts and service-level economics.
OBJ-06	Evaluate stylist performance, staffing utilization and scheduling alignment.
OBJ-07	Use customer feedback to add qualitative context to quantitative findings.
OBJ-08	Translate findings into actionable commercial and operational recommendations.
OBJ-09	Provide management reporting through a Power BI dashboard and live walkthrough.
OBJ-10	Monitor profitability after implementation of necessary recommendations.

5. Stakeholder

Stakeholder	Role in Engagement
Salon Manager	Primary business stakeholder; provided business context, operational concerns and data, reviewed findings and received the final dashboard/recommendations.
Business Analyst + Data Analyst	Gathered requirements, prepared and analyzed data, defined KPIs, performed root-cause analysis, built Power BI reporting and presented recommendations.

6. Scope

6.1 In Scope

- Review and consolidation of approximately one year of available operational data.
- Data cleaning and validation of Excel and handwritten records.
- Appointment/bookings, utilization, cancellation and no-show analysis.
- Customer repeat-visit and retention analysis using available customer information, including phone-number matching for repeat visits.
- Service mix, service revenue, pricing, discounts and service-economics analysis.
- Staff/stylist performance, salaries/commissions, working hours, attendance, utilization and scheduling analysis.
- Revenue, expenses, product/material costs and profitability analysis.
- Qualitative customer-feedback analysis from confirmed available channels.
- Power BI dashboard development from scratch.
- Business recommendations and live walkthrough to management.

6.2 Out of Scope / Not Claimed

- Disclosure of personally identifiable customer data.
- Publication of confidential revenue, expense, salary, commission, pricing, margin or profit values.
- Exact customer, staff, appointment or transaction volumes that are not retained.
- Exact historical peak hour/day values that are not retained.
- Formal enterprise governance artifacts or approvals not confirmed as part of the engagement.
- Unsupported attribution of the 15% profit improvement to one isolated recommendation.

7. Source Data Requirements

Data Domain	Required Information	Business Use
Appointments	Bookings, appointment activity, cancellations/no-shows	Utilization and lost-demand analysis
Services	Services performed and prices	Service mix, pricing and revenue analysis
Customers	Customer identifiers and visit history	Repeat visits and retention
Staff / Stylists	Staff details, working hours, attendance	Performance and utilization
Compensation	Salary and commission information	Cost/profitability analysis
Costs	Product/material costs and expenses	Cost and margin analysis
Commercial	Revenue and discounts	Profitability and pricing analysis
Feedback	Reviews and customer comments	Qualitative root-cause context

8. Business Requirements

ID	Requirement	Business Requirement	Priority
BR-01	Profitability Visibility	The solution shall provide management with visibility into revenue, expenses and profitability over the available analysis period.	High
BR-02	Profitability Drivers	The analysis shall evaluate multiple revenue, cost and operational factors contributing to profitability rather than assume a single cause.	High
BR-03	Appointment Utilization	The solution shall support analysis of appointment utilization and demand patterns.	High
BR-04	Cancellations / No-Shows	The solution shall identify and analyze cancellations and no-shows as a business-performance factor.	High
BR-05	Repeat Customers	The analysis shall identify repeat visits using available customer information, including phone-number data where appropriate.	High
BR-06	Customer Retention	The solution shall support analysis of customer retention/repeat behaviour across the available period.	Medium
BR-07	Service Performance	The solution shall compare service activity and revenue to understand service mix and performance.	High
BR-08	Pricing & Discounts	The analysis shall evaluate service pricing and discount behaviour, including potential underpricing and excessive discounting where supported by data.	High
BR-09	Service Economics	Where sufficient direct cost information is available, the analysis shall compare service revenue with associated direct costs.	High
BR-10	Stylist Performance	The solution shall support comparison of stylist performance using relevant available measures such as appointments, revenue, utilization, repeat customers and feedback.	High
BR-11	Staff Utilization	The analysis shall identify peak-period staffing shortages and periods of staff underutilization.	High
BR-12	Scheduling	The analysis shall assess whether staff scheduling aligns with customer demand patterns.	High
BR-13	Compensation Costs	The analysis shall consider salary and commission costs as part of profitability diagnosis.	High
BR-14	Material / Product Costs	The analysis shall include available product/material costs and operating expenses in profitability assessment.	Medium
BR-15	Customer Feedback	The analysis shall review available qualitative feedback and categorize recurring business themes.	Medium
BR-16	Management Dashboard	The solution shall provide a Power BI dashboard that consolidates the major analytical areas for management review.	High
BR-17	Actionable Recommendations	Findings shall be translated into practical pricing, staffing, scheduling, promotion, discount, service-mix, repeat-customer and cost-control recommendations where supported.	High
BR-18	Outcome Monitoring	The engagement shall support before-and-after profitability comparison following implementation of necessary recommendations.	High

9. Analytical / KPI Requirements

Area	Required Measures / Views
Profitability	Revenue, expenses, profit and before/after profitability comparison
Appointments	Appointment volume/utilization, cancellations and no-shows
Customers	Repeat visits, repeat-customer rate and retention behaviour
Services	Service activity, revenue by service, service mix and pricing/discount analysis
Staff	Revenue by stylist, appointment activity, working hours/utilization, attendance and relevant customer indicators
Costs	Salary/commission, material/product and operating-expense views
Demand	Time/day demand patterns and peak-period analysis
Feedback	Theme/category analysis for pricing, staff behaviour, cleanliness and staff availability

10. Business Definitions

Term	Portfolio Definition / Intent
Profit	Revenue – Expenses at the agreed business reporting level.
Profit Improvement %	$(\text{Profit After Recommendations} - \text{Profit Before Recommendations}) \div \text{Profit Before Recommendations} \times 100$.
Repeat Customer	A customer with multiple visits/appointments identified through available customer data; phone number was used for repeat matching.
Cancellation	A booked appointment recorded as cancelled under the available source-data status.
No-Show	A booked appointment where the customer did not attend, subject to the source-data status/recording method.
Staff Utilization	Comparison of staff availability/working time with appointments, sessions or other available activity indicators.
Peak Demand	Periods showing comparatively higher appointment/customer demand. Historical exact time slots are not retained.
Service Contribution / Margin	Service revenue less associated direct service costs where sufficient cost attribution is available.
Definition control: Exact thresholds, denominators and status mappings must be validated against the sanitized/rebuilt dataset before final KPI implementation. They are not to be invented as historical client rules.	

11. Reporting Requirements

The Power BI solution should provide management with clear analytical visibility across four logical portfolio views:

Logical View	Decision Supported
Executive Profitability Overview	Understand overall business performance and major profitability signals.
Service & Pricing Analysis	Evaluate service mix, pricing, discounts, revenue and service economics.
Staff Performance & Utilization	Compare stylist performance and determine whether staffing/scheduling aligns with demand.
Customer & Appointment Analysis	Understand repeat behaviour, retention, utilization, cancellations/no-shows and demand patterns.

These are recommended logical portfolio views. They are not claims about the exact historical page names or layout of the original client dashboard.

12. Qualitative Feedback Requirements

Confirmed feedback sources included Google reviews, Instagram comments, WhatsApp feedback, surveys, salon records and direct conversations. The analysis should categorize feedback into recurring themes while keeping qualitative evidence separate from transactional financial data.

- Pricing
- Staff behaviour
- Cleanliness
- Staff availability

13. Data Quality Requirements

- Consolidate relevant Excel and handwritten records into an analysis-ready structure.
- Check for duplicate or inconsistent customer records before repeat-customer analysis.
- Standardize dates, service names, staff/stylist names and categorical statuses where necessary.
- Validate revenue, expenses, discounts, costs and compensation fields before profitability calculations.
- Validate appointment status values before cancellation/no-show calculations.
- Reconcile major Power BI KPIs with prepared source/analysis outputs.
- Exclude or document records that cannot be reliably interpreted rather than silently forcing them into a category.

14. Business Rules & Constraints

ID	Rule / Constraint
RC-01	Underlying client financial values and customer-level data remain confidential.
RC-02	The exact original row count/data volume is not retained and shall not be fabricated.
RC-03	The exact historical peak days/hours are not retained; only the general evening/festival-period pattern is confirmed.
RC-04	Phone-number data was used to identify repeat visits; public portfolio outputs must not expose phone numbers.
RC-05	Customer feedback is qualitative supporting evidence and must not be represented as financial transaction data.
RC-06	The 15% profit increase is measured using before/after profit comparison; underlying ₹ values remain confidential.
RC-07	The improvement should not be attributed to a single recommendation because multiple necessary changes were implemented.
RC-08	Any reconstructed field names, thresholds, DAX or dashboard layouts must be labeled as portfolio rebuild logic when not historically retained.

15. Success / Acceptance Criteria

ID	Acceptance Criterion
AC-01	Management can review profitability and its major contributing factors from consolidated analysis.
AC-02	Appointment utilization, cancellations/no-shows and demand patterns can be analyzed.
AC-03	Repeat-customer behaviour can be identified using the available customer matching logic.
AC-04	Service and stylist performance can be compared using available validated data.
AC-05	Staffing and scheduling issues can be assessed against demand/activity patterns.
AC-06	Pricing, discount and cost observations are supported by available data rather than assumptions.
AC-07	Customer feedback themes are summarized separately from structured financial analysis.
AC-08	Power BI KPIs reconcile with the prepared analytical data.
AC-09	Findings lead to actionable management recommendations.
AC-10	The final solution can be explained to management through a live walkthrough.
AC-11	Post-implementation profit can be compared with the pre-implementation baseline without disclosing confidential values.

16. Confirmed Outcome

Measured outcome: Following implementation of the necessary recommendations, profit increased by 15% within approximately two months.

The commercial values used to calculate the before-and-after result are confidential and are intentionally excluded from this portfolio.

17. Assumptions, Unknowns & Evidence Boundaries

Category	Status
Confirmed	Client, project period, direct engagement, BA+DA role, manager stakeholder, ~1 year data, source types, data domains, toolset, dashboard built from scratch, live walkthrough, analytical areas, confirmed staffing/operational issues, recommendations and 15% outcome.
Not Retained	Exact row/customer/staff/appointment counts; exact financial values; exact peak hours/days; exact discount percentages; exact service margins; exact historical SQL/DAX; exact dashboard page names/layout.
Portfolio Reconstruction	This BRD, logical requirement IDs/priorities, reporting-view names, and any future sanitized implementation details not retained from the historical engagement.

18. Requirements Traceability Snapshot

Business Need	Requirements
Diagnose profit decline	BR-01, BR-02, BR-08, BR-09, BR-13, BR-14
Improve appointment economics	BR-03, BR-04, BR-12
Understand customers	BR-05, BR-06, BR-15
Optimize service/pricing decisions	BR-07, BR-08, BR-09
Improve workforce decisions	BR-10, BR-11, BR-12, BR-13
Support management decisions	BR-16, BR-17, BR-18